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The Editors

Dear Editors,

We submit the manuscript *"CLAMP-RT: Falsification-Robust Fairness Control for Federated Graph Learning via a Two-Server Trimmed Statistic with Attribute-Level Differential Privacy"* by Quang-Vinh Dang and Ngoc-Son-An Nguyen for consideration as a research article.

Relation to a previous submission. A previous version of this work, describing a protocol called CLAMP, was submitted to another journal and rejected for lack of sufficient novelty. The reviewers made four specific criticisms: a single client that falsified its group statistics could disable fairness control; the theory was weak (one bound was vacuous in most tested settings, the fairness guarantee covered validation data only, and one proposition was an accounting identity); the privacy guarantee was narrow and its sensitivity relied on a cap that the main experiments computed from attribute-dependent group sizes; and secure aggregation was simulated with no cryptographic cost, using Gaussian rather than discrete noise. We agree with these criticisms. The present manuscript is a redesign, not a revision of the text:

- the statistics channel is replaced: each client secret-shares one scalar gap between two non-colluding servers, which sort, trim and privatise it in two-party computation. We prove that up to b liars cannot move the estimate outside the range of honest values, and in experiments with four fixed attack strategies the liars did not move the outcome away from its honest level up to that point, where one liar disabled the old channel (on graphs where the controller is barely active in honest runs, this shows less than robust control, which the manuscript states);
- the sensitivity is now fixed by a floor computed from public validation-set sizes only, and every reported run uses it;
- the vacuous bound and the accounting identity are removed; the remaining results are stated with their scope, and a bound that becomes vacuous on small graphs is reported as such;
- the server-side protocol is implemented in a two-party computation framework and its time, traffic and rounds are reported.

Limitations stated in the manuscript. The redesign has costs that we report plainly: in honest runs the new protocol controls the fairness gap less tightly than the old one on the graphs where the budget binds; on the three small graphs the privacy noise exceeds the signal; robustness ends at the breakdown point of the trimmed mean; fairness poisoning through model updates is not countered; and the training experiments still run the secure computation in plaintext with continuous Gaussian noise, whose replacement by a discrete mechanism we leave for future work. Adaptive attacks and attacks at a more active release period were not run.

This manuscript is original, has not been published, and is not under consideration elsewhere. It reuses the datasets, baselines and experimental setup of the earlier submission, which are described again in the manuscript. Our earlier conference paper on privacy- and fairness-aware

federated GNNs for fraud detection (FedFairGNN, PMLR 2026) is cited in the related work; the present method and text are not taken from it. All authors have approved the submission. The authors declare no competing interests, and the research received no funding. The datasets are public benchmarks, and the code and per-run results will be made available upon publication.

Yours sincerely,

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